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# Summit Industrial Services, LLC

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SAFETY MANAGEMENT PROGRAM

## Excavation & Trenching Safety Program

29 CFR 1926 Subpart P

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Revision History

| Rev | Date     | Description of Change                                                                  | Approved By |
|-----|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 1.0 | Feb 2024 | Initial issue                                                                          | HSE Manager |
| 2.0 | Mar 2025 | Added competent-person evaluation log; updated soil classification references          | HSE Manager |
| 3.0 | Aug 2026 | Full revision; added atmospheric monitoring & emergency response sections; reformatted | HSE Manager |

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## 1. Purpose

This program establishes the minimum requirements for the safe execution of excavation and trenching operations performed by Summit Industrial Services, LLC. It defines the controls, responsibilities, and inspection practices required to protect employees from cave-ins, falling loads, hazardous atmospheres, and related hazards, in accordance with 29 CFR 1926 Subpart P.

## 2. Scope

This program applies to all Summit Industrial Services, LLC employees, subcontractors, and visitors who perform, supervise, or enter any excavation or trench on company projects. It covers all excavations regardless of depth and all trenches, with additional engineered controls required for excavations 5 feet (1.52 m) deep or greater.

## 3. Responsibilities

|                              |                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Site Superintendent</b>   | Overall accountability for excavation safety on the project; ensures a competent person is designated before any excavation begins.                     |
| <b>Competent Person</b>      | Conducts daily inspections, classifies soil, selects protective systems, and has authority to stop work and remove employees from hazardous conditions. |
| <b>Supervisors / Foremen</b> | Enforce protective-system requirements, verify access/egress, and confirm crews are trained before entry.                                               |
| <b>Employees</b>             | Follow the program, use protective systems as directed, and report changed or hazardous conditions immediately.                                         |

## 4. Definitions

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### Excavation

Any man-made cut, cavity, trench, or depression in an earth surface formed by earth removal.

### Trench

A narrow excavation (measured at the bottom) that is deeper than it is wide, and no wider than 15 feet (4.6 m).

### Competent Person

An individual capable of identifying existing and predictable hazards and who has authorization to take prompt corrective measures to eliminate them.

## 5. Hazard Identification

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The primary hazards associated with excavation and trenching work include:

- Cave-ins and soil collapse — the leading cause of excavation fatalities.
- Falls and falling loads into the excavation.
- Contact with underground and overhead utilities.
- Hazardous atmospheres — oxygen deficiency, toxic or flammable gases.
- Water accumulation and mobile-equipment hazards at the excavation edge.

### **WARNING**

An unprotected trench can collapse in seconds. A cubic yard of soil can weigh over 3,000 lbs — enough to fatally crush or suffocate a worker before rescue is possible.

## 6. Competent Person

A designated competent person shall be present at every excavation. This individual is responsible for soil classification, selection and inspection of protective systems, atmospheric testing where required, and daily inspections. The competent person has the authority to stop work.

### NOTE

The competent person must be present on site whenever employees are exposed to potential excavation hazards — not merely on call.

## 7. Soil Classification

The competent person shall classify soil using at least one visual and one manual analysis. Maximum allowable slopes for excavations less than 20 feet deep are:

| Soil Type          | Description                                                                                           | Max Allowable Slope |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Stable Rock</b> | Natural solid mineral matter that can be excavated with vertical sides and remain intact.             | Vertical            |
| <b>Type A</b>      | Cohesive soils with unconfined compressive strength $\geq 1.5$ tsf (e.g., clay, silty clay, hardpan). | 3/4 : 1 (53°)       |
| <b>Type B</b>      | Cohesive soil 0.5–1.5 tsf; granular cohesionless soils; previously disturbed soils.                   | 1 : 1 (45°)         |
| <b>Type C</b>      | Cohesive soil $< 0.5$ tsf; submerged soil or soil with freely seeping water; sand/gravel.             | 1½ : 1 (34°)        |

### CAUTION

Soil that has been previously disturbed, is subject to vibration, or is showing signs of water seepage must be downgraded one classification (never classified above Type B).

## 8. Protective Systems

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Excavations 5 feet or deeper require a protective system unless made entirely in stable rock. Acceptable systems include sloping, benching, shoring, and shielding (trench boxes). Protective systems must be selected based on soil classification, depth, water conditions, and adjacent loads.

### **WARNING**

Never enter an unprotected excavation 5 feet or deeper. Protective systems must be installed before entry and removed only after all employees have exited.

## 9. Access and Egress

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A stairway, ladder, ramp, or other safe means of egress shall be provided in trench excavations 4 feet or deeper, located so as to require no more than 25 feet (7.6 m) of lateral travel for employees.

## 10. Daily Inspections

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The competent person shall inspect excavations, adjacent areas, and protective systems daily before work begins, as needed throughout the shift, and after every rainstorm or other hazard-increasing event. Inspection findings shall be documented on the daily excavation inspection log.

### NOTE

If the competent person finds evidence of a possible cave-in, protective-system failure, hazardous atmosphere, or other hazardous condition, exposed employees must be removed until the hazard is corrected.

## 11. Underground Utilities

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Utility locates (e.g., 811) shall be requested and confirmed before excavation. While excavation is in progress, underground installations shall be protected, supported, or removed as necessary to safeguard employees.



## 12. Water Accumulation

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Employees shall not work in excavations with accumulated water unless adequate precautions (special support, water removal, safety harnesses) are in place. A competent person shall monitor water-removal equipment.

## 13. Hazardous Atmospheres

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Where a hazardous atmosphere exists or could reasonably be expected (excavations > 4 feet deep, or near landfills or hazardous substances), the atmosphere shall be tested before entry and monitored throughout. Adequate ventilation or respiratory protection shall be provided as required.

### **WARNING**

Oxygen-deficient or toxic atmospheres are invisible and can incapacitate a worker within a single breath. Test the atmosphere before entry — never rely on sight or smell.

## **14. Emergency Response**

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An emergency response plan shall be established for each excavation site. Employees shall never enter a collapsed trench to attempt a rescue. Emergency services and trained rescue personnel shall be summoned; on-site personnel shall provide information and secure the area.

## **15. Training**

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All employees who work in or around excavations shall be trained on the hazards, the protective systems in use, and the requirements of this program prior to assignment. Competent persons shall receive additional training in soil classification, protective-system selection, and inspection.

## 16. Recordkeeping

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The following records shall be maintained and available on site: daily inspection logs, competent-person designations, soil-classification determinations, atmospheric-testing results, and training records. Records shall be retained per company policy and applicable regulation.

## 17. Program Enforcement

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Compliance with this program is mandatory. Violations may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination. Any employee may stop work for a suspected excavation hazard without fear of reprisal.

## 18. References

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- 29 CFR 1926 Subpart P — Excavations (1926.650–652 and Appendices A–F)
- OSHA Publication 2226 — Trenching and Excavation Safety
- Company HSE Manual — Section on Ground Disturbance

# Approval

This program has been reviewed and approved for implementation.

|                                |                 |
|--------------------------------|-----------------|
| <div>Prepared By / Title</div> | <div>Date</div> |
| <div>Reviewed By / Title</div> | <div>Date</div> |
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